

DECENT COACHING CLASSES

English Grammar

Master Class

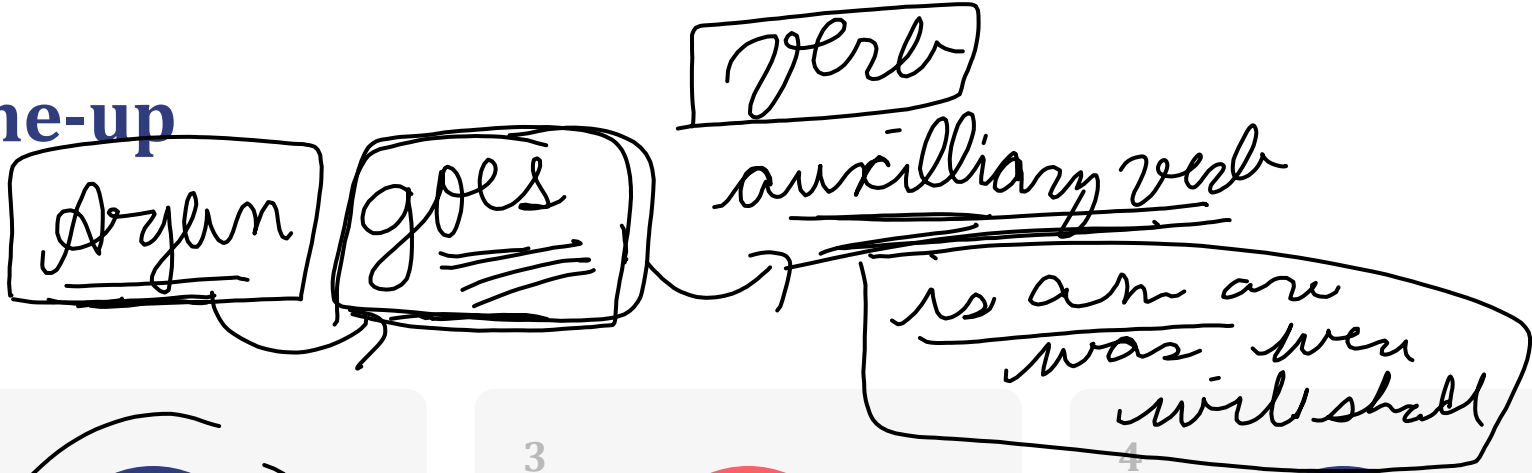
Parts of Speech • Subject-Verb Agreement • Question Tags • Prepositions

Class 1 | 3rd August

For Classes VIII, IX & X — Maharashtra Board & NCERT

Today's Grammar Line-up

Four building blocks every board exam tests



1

Parts of Speech

The 8 building blocks of every sentence

2

Subject-Verb Agreement

Making subjects and verbs shake hands correctly

3

Question Tags

The little tags that turn statements into questions

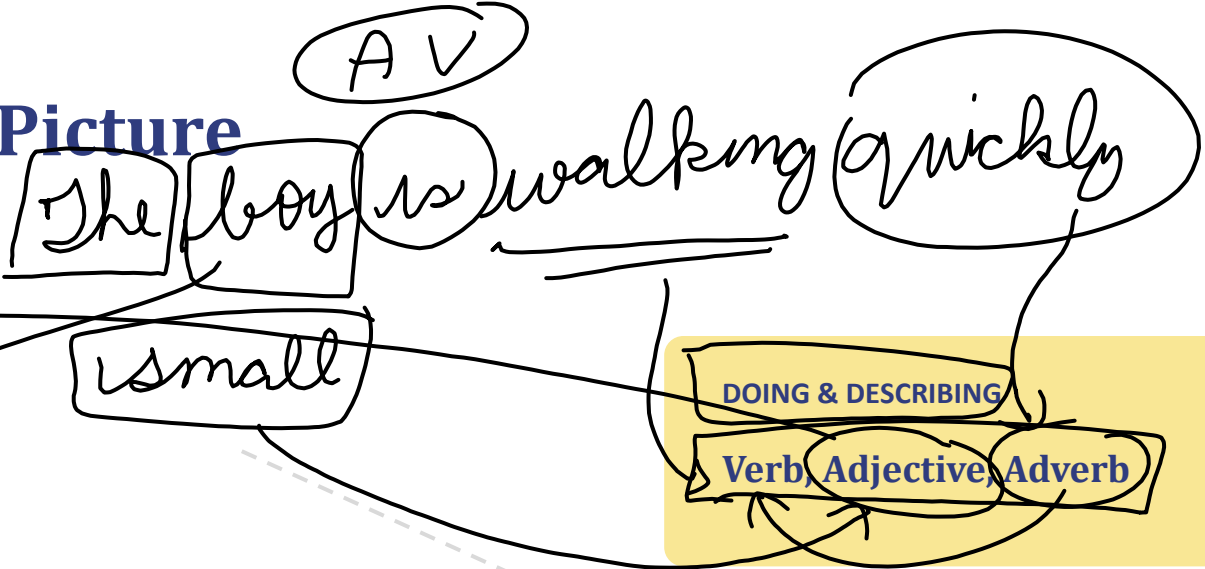
4

Prepositions

Tiny words that show place, time & direction

Parts of Speech — The Big Picture

Every one of the 8 categories belongs to one of these 4 jobs

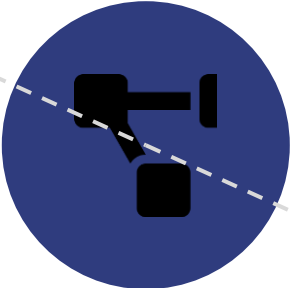


NAMING & REPLACING

Noun, Pronoun

DOING & DESCRIBING

Verb, Adjective, Adverb



8 PARTS OF SPEECH

CONNECTING

Preposition, Conjunction

EXPRESSING FEELING

Interjection

Noun

A noun is the naming word for any person, place, thing, or idea

monument T M.

Boys → Plural
class → singular



Common Noun

General name for any person, place or thing (not capitalised)



boy, city, river

Proper Noun

The particular / specific name of a person, place or thing — always capitalised

Rahul, Pune, Ganga

Collective Noun

Name for a group or collection treated as one unit

team, herd, jury

Material Noun

Name for the substance or material something is made of

gold, wood, water

Abstract Noun

Name for a quality, feeling, or idea that cannot be touched

happy boy

honesty, joy, freedom

→ happiness

Compound Noun

Two or more words joined to form one naming word

toothpaste, mother-in-law

Pronoun

A pronoun stands IN PLACE of a noun, so we don't repeat it again and again



Personal

Refers to a specific person or thing

I, you, he, she, it, we, they

Demonstrative

Points to a specific thing

this, that, these, those

Interrogative

Used to ask questions

who, what, which, whose

Relative

Joins a clause back to a noun

who, which, that, whom

Indefinite

Refers to a non-specific person/thing

someone, anybody, everyone

Reflexive

Reflects the action back on the subject

myself, himself, themselves

She (Personal) baked the cake all by herself (Reflexive).
Who (Interrogative) left this (Demonstrative) on the table?

Verb

A verb shows an action or a state of being — every sentence needs one

He is a boy (be)

(be)



Main (Principal) Verb

Carries the real meaning/action of the sentence

She sings every morning.

Transitive Verb

Action passes on to a direct object

Riya wrote a letter. (letter = object)

Finite Verb

Changes with subject/tense — forms a complete sentence

He plays. / He played.

Helping (Auxiliary) Verb

Supports the main verb — shows tense, mood or voice

She is singing / has sung.

Intransitive Verb

Action does NOT pass on to any object

The baby sleeps peacefully.

Non-Finite Verb

Does not change with subject/tense (infinitives, gerunds, participles)

To play is fun. Playing is fun.

He sings a song
~~He~~ wants to sing a song
He loves singing
They

To

Adjective

syllable



An adjective describes or adds detail to a noun or pronoun

Degrees of Comparison (a favourite exam topic)

er

x

est

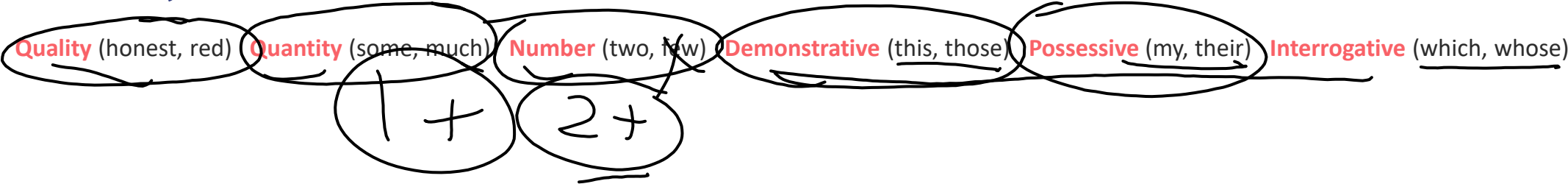
Positive	Comparative	Superlative
tall	taller	tallest
good	better	best
beautiful	more beautiful	most beautiful
little	less	least

Bad

worse

worst

Kinds of Adjectives



Adverb

An adverb adds detail to a verb, an adjective, or even another adverb

-ly



Manner

Tells HOW something is done

slowly, carefully, well

Place

Tells WHERE something happens

here, there, everywhere

Time

Tells WHEN something happens

today, soon, yesterday

Frequency

Tells HOW OFTEN it happens

always, often, never

daily

Degree

Tells HOW MUCH / to what extent

very, quite, almost

Interrogative

Used to ask a question

why, where, when

Conjunction & Interjection

Joining words, and the words that show sudden feeling



CONJUNCTION — joins words, phrases or clauses

Coordinating

Joins two equal / similar ideas — F.A.N.B.O.Y.S

for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so

acronym

Subordinating

Joins a main clause to a dependent clause

because, although, if, when

If you give me maggot

Half

Correlative

Used in pairs to join balanced ideas

either...or, neither...nor, not only...but also

INTERJECTION — shows sudden feeling or emotion

Strong feeling → followed by an exclamation mark (!)

Wow! Alas! Hurray! Ouch!

Mild feeling → followed by a comma (,)

Well, I suppose so. Oh, is that so?

Sarcasm

Wow! (Strong Interjection) We wanted to go for a walk, **but** (Coordinating Conjunction) it suddenly started to rain.

Well, (Mild Interjection) we can stay indoors **because** (Subordinating Conjunction) I just bought a new board game.

You can choose **either** the chocolate cake **or** (Correlative Conjunction) the vanilla ice cream for dessert.

Ouch! (Strong Interjection) I stubbed my toe on the table, **so** (Coordinating Conjunction) I need to sit down for a minute.

Spot the Parts of Speech

One sentence, eight jobs

Wow! The **clever** girl **quickly** finished her homework **and** slept.

● **Wow** — Interjection

● **clever** — Adjective

● **girl** — Noun

● **quickly** — Adverb

● **and** — Conjunction

● **finished / slept** — Verb



A word's part of speech isn't fixed — it depends on the JOB it does in that sentence. "Book" is a noun in "read a book" but a verb in "book a ticket"!

Previous Year Questions

Parts of Speech



Q1. Pick out the noun, pronoun, adjective and verb: "The brave soldier saved his friend."

PN N

Adv N Verb

4 M

SB — 8

Q2. Identify the part of speech of the underlined words: "She sings beautifully but softly."

Adv

2 M

CBSE — 9

Q3. State the part of speech of the italicised word: "Alas! we have lost the match."

1 M

SB — 10

Q4. Use the word "light" as a noun, a verb and an adjective in three separate sentences.

This is a light
She is lighting a diya
Feather is very light

3 M

CBSE — 8

Q5. Name the kind of noun underlined: "The jury gave its verdict."

1 M

SB — 9

Q6. Fill in with a suitable correlative conjunction: "___ Sam ___ Priya was present."

1 M

CBSE — 10

Subject-Verb Agreement



Core rule: singular subject → singular verb; plural subject → plural verb. Now the exceptions:

1. "YOU" always takes a PLURAL verb, even for one person.

You are asked to clean the room.

2. Sentence begins with HERE / THERE — verb agrees with the subject AFTER it.

There is a huge gap between the rich and the poor.

3. EITHER/OR, NEITHER/NOR (one singular + one plural) — verb agrees with the NEARER subject.

Neither the players nor the coach is joining.

4. WITH / AS WELL AS / ACCOMPANIED BY / TOGETHER WITH does NOT change the verb.

Jake, accompanied by his sisters, is enrolling.

5. Two subjects joined by AND — usually take a PLURAL verb.

Larry and Mercy are reading novels.

6. Two SINGULAR subjects joined by EITHER/OR, NEITHER/NOR — singular verb.

Either Mommy or Daddy is coming.

Subject-Verb Agreement

Rules 7 to 12 — quantities, indefinite pronouns & phrases



7. Singular subject + phrase with a plural noun — verb stays SINGULAR.

One of the boys is yelling so loud.

8. SEVERAL / FEW / BOTH / MANY / OTHERS are always PLURAL.

Both were asking to be freed.

9. "SOME OF" + noun — verb agrees with that noun.

Some of the ice-cream is left. Some of the girls were absent.

10. EVERYBODY / EACH / NOBODY / EVERYONE / SOMEONE etc. — always SINGULAR.

Every man and woman in this hall is a member.

11. Money / time / distance treated as ONE unit — SINGULAR verb.

Two years is a long time to wait.

12. Money / units counted SEPARATELY — PLURAL verb.

Five 25-centavo coins were found.

Subject-Verb Agreement

Rules 13 to 18 — tricky nouns that look one way but behave another



13. SCISSORS / TROUSERS / PLIERS always PLURAL — but "A PAIR OF ___" is SINGULAR.

Scissors are broken

The pair of scissors was placed on the table.

14. Mathematics / News (look plural, aren't) — SINGULAR verb.

Mathematics is my favourite subject.

15. "A NUMBER OF" = PLURAL. "THE NUMBER OF" = SINGULAR.

A number of students are waiting outside.

16. Fractions — verb agrees with the object of the "OF" phrase.

One fourth of the employees were attending.

17. POLITICS / GYMNASTICS / STATISTICS — singular as one subject, plural as separate activities.

Gymnastics is very popular among girls.

18. Country names ending in 's' but naming ONE place — SINGULAR.

The Philippines is a wondrous place.

Subject-Verb Agreement

Rules 19 to 24 — collective nouns, titles, organisations & "it"



19. "THE + adjective" (the poor, the rich) means a group of people — PLURAL verb.

The poor are to be helped.

20. Collective nouns (team, jury, committee) — SINGULAR as one unit, PLURAL if members act separately.

The committee is against the plan. / The committee are of different opinion.

21. Maths expressions: PLUS/AND → is or are; MINUS → is; TIMES → are.

Seven plus three is ten. Five times two are ten.

22. Titles of books, plays or movies — always SINGULAR, even if the title looks plural.

"Great Expectations" is a must-read novel.

23. Organisation names — SINGULAR for the whole body, PLURAL for its members.

Lopez & Sons

Lopez and Sons is a successful organization.

24. Sentence begins with the expletive "IT" — always SINGULAR.

It is the schools which must assume the responsibility.

Previous Year Questions

Subject-Verb Agreement



Q1. Choose the correct verb: "Each of the students has/have) submitted the assignment."

1 M

CBSE — 9

Q2. Rewrite correcting the error: "My family ^{is} are planning a trip to Goa."

collective

2 M

SB — 10

Q3. Fill in the blank: "Neither the manager nor the workers are satisfied."

1 M

SB — 8

Q4. Identify and correct the error: "The jury has given their individual opinions."

have ?

2 M

CBSE — 10

Q5. Choose the correct option: "The number of accidents is/are) increasing every year."

1 M

SB — 9

Q6. Correct the sentence: "Mathematics are a difficult subject for many."

is

2 M

CBSE — 8

Question Tags — How They Work



A tag is formed from the auxiliary/modal verb of the sentence + a matching subject pronoun

1. Positive statement → NEGATIVE tag

Karen is learning to drive, isn't she?
Kate will be here soon, won't she?

2. Negative statement → POSITIVE tag

Kate won't be late, will she?
They don't like us, do they?

*This sun
rises from east,*

3. No auxiliary in the sentence? Borrow DO / DOES / DID

John doesn't like golf, does he?
They left for Milan, didn't they?

*does
~~do~~
did*

The subject in the tag is always a PRONOUN, never the noun repeated: Rita is late, isn't SHE (not isn't Rita)?

Question Tags — Special Verb Forms

These 8 patterns don't follow the plain formula — memorise them as fixed pairs



E > C

I am
tag: aren't I?
I am thin, aren't I?

Imperative *Real order command*
tag: will/won't you?
Stop talking, will you?

Don't ...
tag: will you?
Don't talk, will you?

Let's ...
tag: shall we?
Let's go out, shall we?

I have got *(be)*
tag: haven't I?
She has got a bike, hasn't she?

I have (other)
tag: don't I?
You have lunch at three, don't you?

There is / are
tag: isn't / aren't there?
There is an envelope on the desk, isn't there?

This / That is
tag: isn't it?
This is Pam's shirt, isn't it?

I had had a bike

Question Tags — Pronoun Choice & Negative Words



Two more rules examiners love to test

Which pronoun goes in the tag?

ANYTHING / NOTHING / EVERYTHING / SOMETHING → **IT**

SOMEBODY / SOMEONE / EVERYBODY / EVERYONE / ANYBODY / ANYONE /
NOBODY / NO ONE → **THEY**

Everybody is thinking about the quiz, aren't they?

Practice — add the correct tag

Tom won't be late, ___?

Let's have dinner, ___?

Negative-meaning words → POSITIVE tag

NEVER, HARDLY, SELDOM, RARELY already make the sentence negative in MEANING, even without "not" — so the tag flips positive.

He never plays tennis, does he?

My mother rarely goes out, does she?

Ann is Ann's

Ann's on holiday, ___?

Nobody was watching TV, ___?

Previous Year Questions

Question Tags



Q1. Add a suitable question tag: "You have finished your homework, ____?"

1 M

SB — 8

Q2. Add a suitable question tag: "Let's play a game, ____?"

1 M

CBSE — 9

Q3. Add a suitable question tag: "Nobody called me yesterday, ____?"

1 M

did

SB — 10

Q4. Rewrite adding an appropriate tag: "She won't come to the party."

2 M

CBSE — 8

Q5. Add a question tag: "I am your best friend, ____?"

1 M

SB — 9

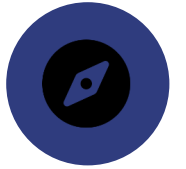
Q6. Add a question tag: "Everyone loves a rainy day, ____?"

1 M

CBSE — 10

Prepositions of Time — AT / IN / ON

The three basics, with the exact rule behind each



an exact point in time • a holiday period of 2-3 days

at 10:15 a.m. • at Christmas, at Diwali, at the weekend



a longer period • a part of the day

in the 20th century, in summer • in the morning, in the evening



a specific day or date

on Sunday • on 15th March

No preposition before today / yesterday / tomorrow / the day after / next: "I am going out tomorrow" (not "on tomorrow").

Prepositions of Time — Fine Distinctions



The pairs examiners use to test real understanding, not just memory

IN TIME vs ON TIME

IN TIME = before the appointed time (not late). ON TIME = exactly at the arranged time.

Be at the station in time for the train. / The train started on time.

IN vs WITHIN vs BEFORE

IN = at the end of a period. WITHIN = before a period expires.
BEFORE = a fixed point.

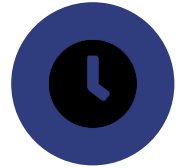
Return in a week / Return within a week. / Return before 15th March.

AFTER vs IN (future)

AFTER = end of a PAST period. IN = end of a FUTURE period.

They returned after a month. / They will return in a month.

Prepositions of Time — Duration Words



FOR / SINCE / AGO / TILL-UNTIL / BY — each answers a different question

FOR

a period/duration of time

I stayed in Mumbai for a month.

SINCE

a point in time (with Perfect tense)

I have been here since 1999.

AGO

a past action, measured back from NOW

I joined the school nine years ago.

TILL / UNTIL

when something finishes / continues up to

He sat in the shop till closing time.

BY

not later than

I get up by 6 o'clock.

Prepositions of Place — AT vs IN

Same two words as time, but now about location



Small towns/villages → AT. Big cities/states/countries → IN.

He lives at Udupi in Karnataka.

Enclosed / within an area → IN. Not enclosed / a point → AT.

In a bag, in the room. / At the crossroads, at the bus stop.

An activity taking place there → AT.

The Manager is working at his table.

Prepositions of Place — Rest vs Motion, and More Pairs



Five more pairs students constantly confuse

IN / INTO

rest inside
motion towards the inside

They are in the room. I went into the house.

ON / UPON

rest on a surface
motion onto something

They sat on the floor. / The cat sprang upon the table.

BETWEEN / AMONG

two people/things
more than two

Divide the bananas between the two children. / They quarrelled among themselves.

BESIDE / BESIDES

by the side of
in addition to

They sat beside him. / Besides singing, she plays the piano.

ABOVE / OVER

more space between two things
very close to / covering

The plane flew above the clouds. / He put nets over the plants.

Prepositions — Fill in the Blanks

Classwork: complete each sentence with the correct preposition



on

1. The stranger knocked ___ the door.

into

2. Suddenly he jumped ___ the pool.

beside

3. He was standing ___ the pillar.

b/w

5. He sat ___ Harry and Manas.

over

6. He presided ___ the meeting.

at

7. There is a bus stop ___ the end of the road.

1 h

8. We will finish our homework ___ an hour.

Previous Year Questions

M. W.



Prepositions

Q1. Fill in the blanks: "The train arrived ____ the station ____ 6 o'clock."

2 M

SB — 8

Q2. Choose the correct preposition: "She is good ____ (in/at) Mathematics."

1 M

CBSE — 9

Q3. Rewrite using the correct preposition: "He is married with a doctor."

1 M

SB — 10

Q4. Complete with a preposition of movement: "The boy ran ____ the field to catch the ball."

1 M

CBSE — 8

Q5. Correct the error: "I am living here since two years."

2 M

SB — 9

Q6. Fill in the blank: "He is afraid ____ the dark."

1 M

CBSE — 10

Quick Recap



Parts of Speech

8 jobs a word can do — Noun, Pronoun, Verb, Adjective, Adverb, Preposition, Conjunction, Interjection



Subject-Verb Agreement

Singular subject → singular verb; watch collective nouns, or/nor, and 'the number of' vs 'a number of'



Question Tags

Flip the polarity, echo the same auxiliary, match the pronoun — with special rules for I am, Let's & imperatives



Prepositions

AT = point, ON = day/surface, IN = period/enclosed space — plus fixed phrases like 'good at', 'afraid of'



Practice Makes Perfect!

Homework: solve the worksheet on all four topics before the next class.

Questions? Ask now!